

“Want is one only of five giants on the road of **reconstruction...** the others are Disease, Ignorance, Squalor, and Idleness.”

WILLIAM BEVERIDGE, ARCHITECT OF THE WELFARE STATE, 1942

UNITED KINGDOM

BRITISH OVERSEAS TERRITORIES

ANGUILLA

Island in northeast Caribbean.

1650 First colonized by British settlers.

1825 Administered by St. Kitts.

1967 Reverts to direct British rule.

BERMUDA

Islands in west Atlantic.

1609 First colonized by British.

1968 Internal self-government.

1995 Rejects independence from UK.

BRITISH ANTARCTIC TERRITORY

British territorial claim in Antarctica.

1962 Separate from Falklands Dependency.

BRITISH INDIAN OCEAN TERRITORY

Uninhabited military bases used by US.

1965 Created by taking islands from Mauritius and Seychelles to form US and UK naval and air base; all residents expelled.

BRITISH VIRGIN ISLANDS

Island group in northern Caribbean.

1648 Settled by Dutch; by British in 1666.

1672 Made a British crown colony.

CAYMAN ISLANDS

Island group in western Caribbean.

1670 Recognized as British possessions.

1863 Administered by Jamaica, but remain British on Jamaican independence in 1962.

FALKLAND ISLANDS

Islands off the coast of Argentina.

1592 First visited by English sailors.

1765–66 British settlement is established, which Spain recognizes in 1771, but withdrawn in 1774 for economic reasons. A Spanish garrison is also withdrawn in 1811, leaving islands uninhabited.

1820 Buenos Aires government sends ship to the islands to proclaim its sovereignty as successor to former Spanish colonial power.

1829 United Provinces of La Plata appoints a governor to the islands.

1833 UK sovereignty established after UK warships expel Argentinians in 1831–32.

1982 Argentinian forces invade and occupy Falklands and install Argentinian governor. UK dispatches a task force, forcing Argentinian surrender after six weeks of fighting; about 1,000 people are killed.

1995 Agreement reached with Argentina on division of oil and gas exploration revenues in offshore waters; breaks down in 2007.

GIBRALTAR

Rocky peninsula of southern Spain.

1704 British seize Gibraltar from Spain during War of the Spanish Succession.

1713 Treaty of Utrecht cedes rock to Britain.

1830 Gibraltar becomes a crown colony.

1963 Spain revives claim to Gibraltar and begins to blockade the rock.

1967 In a referendum, Gibraltarians vote overwhelmingly to maintain links with UK.

1969 New constitution allows full internal self-government and guarantees sovereignty over Gibraltar will not be relinquished to Spain against wishes of Gibraltarian people.

1977 Talks between UK and Spain include, for the first time, Gibraltarian representatives.

1985 Spain–Gibraltar border fully reopened.

2006 Gibraltar, Spain, and UK meet as equals for first time and agree to confidence-building measures; new constitution gives more powers to Gibraltar.

MONTSERRAT

Volcanic island in eastern Caribbean.

1632 First colonized by British.

1958 British crown colony.

1995–97 Soufrière Hills volcanic eruption causes evacuation of most of island.

PITCAIRN ISLAND

Isolated Pacific islands with population of 48.

1790 Occupied by HMS *Bounty* mutineers.

ST. HELENA

Island group including Ascension and Tristan da Cunha.

1659 Administered by East India Company.

1821 Napoleon dies in exile on St. Helena.

1961 Volcanic eruption causes complete evacuation of Tristan da Cunha for two years.

SOUTH GEORGIA & SANDWICH ISLANDS

Island group north of Antarctica.

1775 Claimed for Britain by Captain Cook.

TURKS & CAICOS ISLANDS

Island group south of Bahamas in Caribbean.

1766 British take control.

1973 Separated from the Bahamas.

The Duke of Wellington, successful commander of forces in the Peninsular War of 1808–14 that evicts the French from Spain and Portugal, finally defeats Napoleon at Waterloo in 1815.

1801 **Act of Union** with Ireland creates the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Ireland.

1807 **The slave trade**, but not slavery, is abolished throughout the British Empire.

1820–30 **The Prince Regent** is king as George IV. He is succeeded by his brother, William IV.

1825 **Stockton to Darlington** railway opens, the world's first public railroad line.

1829 **After considerable agitation**, the Catholic Relief Act is passed, allowing Roman Catholics to stand for parliament.

1829 **Robert Peel** founds the Metropolitan Police Force in London.

1832 **The Great Reform Act** is passed, conferring voting rights on middle-class men and redistributing parliamentary seats on a fairer basis. Working-class men are enfranchised by the Reform Acts of 1867 and 1884, while the property qualification for all members of parliament is abolished in 1858 and the secret ballot introduced in 1872. However, women are not yet allowed to vote or stand for parliament.

1833 **Slavery is finally** abolished throughout the British Empire.

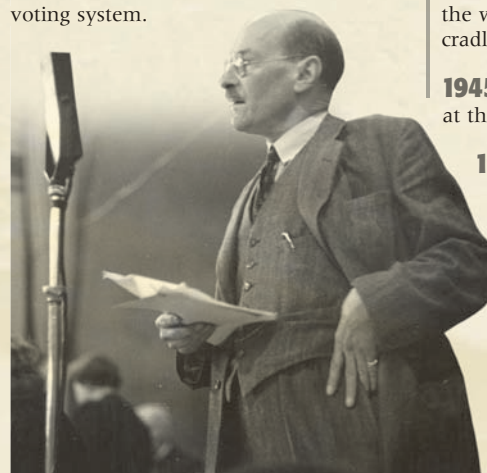
1834 **Poor Law Act** is passed, creating workhouses for the poor.

1834 **The Tolpuddle Martyrs** are transported to Australia for attempting to form a trade union.

1835 **The Municipal Reform Act** is passed, requiring members of town councils to be elected by taxpayers.

1837–1901 **Victoria is queen**, succeeding her uncle, William IV. She becomes the longest-serving British monarch.

1838 **The six-point People's Charter** is issued by the Chartists, who campaign for further reform of the voting system.



1840 **Penny post** introduced, the first flat-rate postal service in the world.

1846 **Home Secretary** Robert Peel repeals the Corn Laws, imposed from 1815 to control the import and export of grain.

1851 **Great Exhibition** held in London.

1861 **Prince Albert**, consort of Queen Victoria, dies. Victoria goes into mourning for 13 years, refusing to appear in public.

1867 **Canada becomes the first** dominion or independent state in British Empire.

1868 **William Gladstone** becomes prime minister, heading the first of his four reforming governments.

1877 **Queen Victoria** is declared Empress of India, as Britain approaches its zenith as an imperial power.

1906 **Reformist Liberal government** introduces old-age pensions and national insurance. To pay for this, it taxes the rich, causing a major constitutional crisis with the aristocratic House of Lords, solved by the 1911 Parliament Act, which drastically reduces its powers.

1914 **World War I** begins.

1918 **Armistice ends** the war; 750,000 dead and many millions injured.

1918 **Women over the** age of 30 can now vote and stand for parliament. The first woman takes her seat in 1919. Women finally gain voting equality in 1928.

1924 **First, minority, Labour** government is elected under Ramsay MacDonald.

1926 **General Strike** in support of the miners fails in its objectives.

1936 **Edward VIII abdicates** over marriage to Mrs. Simpson, a divorcee. His brother becomes king as George VI.

1939 **UK declares war on Germany** after it invades Poland at start of World War II.

1940 **Winston Churchill** becomes prime minister.

1942 **The Beveridge Report** proposes the creation of a welfare state at the end of the war to support people “from the cradle to the grave.”

1945 **World War II** ends with victory, at the cost of 330,000 British lives.

1945 **Labour government** of Clement Attlee wins massive majority over Churchill's Conservatives.

1946 **Nationalization of Bank** of England, railroads, coal, and public utilities.

Clement Attlee

Prime minister from 1945–51, Attlee transformed Britain by introducing the National Health Service and by nationalizing industries.

1775 **James Watt** invents the first effective steam engine; other inventions follow and the Industrial Revolution gathers pace in Britain.

1793–1815 **Britain goes to war** with revolutionary and Napoleonic France. Horatio Nelson defeats the French at the naval battles of the Nile (1798) and Trafalgar (1805), where he loses his life.